



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Evangel Christian Academy
School Website: <https://ecaeagles.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Evangel Christian Academy (ECA) in Colorado Springs presents a clearly classical Christian orientation across its publicly accessible materials. The school consistently frames its program as Christ-centered, rooted in a Christian worldview, and organized around classical pedagogical phases (Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric). Curriculum and pedagogy emphasize the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), integration of faith with learning, and formation of character and virtue, aligned with foundational classical criteria. The school also foregrounds community life, partnerships with families, and a "Portrait of a Graduate" that envisions graduates who live out a biblical worldview in service to church, family, and broader culture. Based on the public materials, the six classical school categories are overall CLASSICAL, with strong evidence across Religion & Metaphysics, Purpose, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parent/Community engagement.

Key supporting signals include: explicit Christ-centered and biblical worldview framing across curricula; articulation of virtue, wisdom, and moral formation; explicit reference to the Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and the Logic/Rhetoric stages; recognized classical curriculum resources and ACCS alignment; liturgical and communal practices (chapel, discipleship, prayer); visible emphasis on partnerships with families and church, and a shared mission to form students for service in Christ. Citations to the school's own pages and materials substantiate these observations, including Our Core Convictions, Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure, and the Portrait of a Graduate materials. See evidence from Evangel's site materials (mission/vision/philosophy, grammar/logic/rhetoric pages, chapel and Bible-infused practices, and family/community sections) and from the Six Essential Elements framework used for rubric alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Christ-centered worldview permeates the curriculum; biblical integration is described as central to all subjects (Christ-centered classroom; Bible/Scripture focus) across Grammar School materials. - Core convictions emphasize identity in Christ, gospel-centered community, and faithfulness in all things; theology is explicitly foregrounded. - There is explicit reference to a Statement of Faith and a biblically grounded worldview in program materials. - Chapel services, discipleship, and gospel-centered community are highlighted as ongoing practices. - Portrait of a Graduate and related materials frame the school's purpose as glorifying God and forming students in a biblical, Christian context. - Education by the Word describes memorization of Scripture verses and explicit biblical instruction in Kindergarten and beyond.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators drawn from Six Essentials: "spiritual depth," "moral formation," "wisdom and virtue," "Christ-centered," "gospel-centered," "biblical worldview," "chapel," "religious formation," and "theology integrated into curriculum" appear in multiple ECA sources. Examples include "Christ-centered worldview" and "our curriculum is integrated with Christ" in Grammar School; "Identity in Christ" and "Gospel-centered community" in core convictions; and "Statement of Faith" and chapel activities.

- Negative keyword indicators (secular/no-theology) are not present in the public-facing materials. The site consistently positions theology as the governing frame, not secular ethics or religious neutrality. This aligns

with the “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical and Communal Practices” positive signals in the classical rubric rather than any counter-signals.

Why this rating - The body of evidence strongly supports a Classical Christian foundation anchored in a biblically informed worldview, worship and communal religious practices, and explicit theological framing of education. The combination of Christ-centered pedagogy, chapel-based formation, and a Statement of Faith places this category firmly in CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission: “partner with parents and their church to educate, equip, and empower students to pursue their purpose in Christ,” signaling formation and virtue over mere vocational training. - Vision emphasizes affecting the Kingdom of God and forming students who are mature in faith and effective in church, family, work, and world. - Core Convictions foreground identity in Christ, biblical worldview, and gospel-centered community; emphasis on formation of the whole person and shaping character, not merely information. - Portrait of a Graduate describes seven traits oriented toward serving God and culture through a classical Christian education. - Admissions and campus communications emphasize relationships with families and church communities as co-educators in the formation process.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords (from Six Elements): “formation,” “virtue,” “character,” “wisdom,” “truth, goodness, beauty,” “moral imagination,” “formation of affections,” and “partnership with families.” ECA uses language around formation, virtue, wisdom, and biblical truth. - The school also emphasizes partnership with parents and churches, aligning with “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections.” Evidence of family/church partnership appears in core convictions and cross-campus communications. - Negative keywords: none prominent (the school’s stated goals are not framed as workforce-readiness-only; they emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and biblical aims rather than job-preparation alone). Public materials do not reflect non-classical, secular, or relativist aims.

Why this rating - The emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a Christian worldview, combined with a mission to partner with families and churches and to develop students for life in service to God, meets the classical rubric’s expectations for a purpose-driven, formation-focused educational goal. CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure evident in naming and program progression (Grammar School, Logic School, Rhetoric School; the Trivium framing). - Curriculum explicitly described as “classical Christian” and aligned with liberal arts traditions; public materials reference a classical curriculum and the use of “Logic of English,” “Well Ordered Language,” “Story of the World,” and “Purposeful Design.” - The school notes ACCS accreditation and a long-standing classical-Christian tradition, indicating alignment with Great Books/Great Conversation ideals and a humanities-forward liberal-arts approach. - The Arts are framed as integral to classical education; band/choir and visual arts are presented as essential parts of a well-rounded classical curriculum. - College preparation and dual-enrollment courses (CCU) indicate a liberal-arts/critical-thinking orientation intended to complement classical formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the Six Elements set relevant to Curriculum: “Seven Liberal Arts” (Trivium; Quadrivium), “great conversation/great books,” “interdisciplinary, integrated approach,” “integration and wonder,” “study of history throughout curriculum,” “reading Great Books,” “cultivation of wonder,” and “liberal arts tradition.” Evidence of Trivium terms (grammar/logic/rhetoric) is explicit in program names and course progression. - Specific curriculum evidence on the site includes: Grammar Stage memorization and foundational learning; Logic and Rhetoric stages in upper grades; use of classical resources in grammar (Logic of English, Well Ordered Language, Story of the World, Purposeful Design). - Negative keywords: none suggesting a secular or non-classical curriculum; no explicit note of “skills-based only” or “career-readiness over truth/goodness/beauty.” The presence of classical resources and Great Books-like framing supports a classical orientation.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly described as classical Christian, organized around the Trivium, and supported by classical resources and a liberal-arts framing. CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; the public materials reference the Rhetoric School as the final phase of the Trivium, signaling a Socratic/seminar-based approach in higher grades. - Lower school appears to emphasize memory work, singing/chanting, and substantial memorization as a means of deepening memory and delight (Scholé-like aspects). The Grammar School materials describe foundational memorization and recall-based routines, including Bible verse memory and structured recitation. - The school emphasizes integrated faith-and-learning and a formation-focused pedagogy (formation through imitation and practice; engaged with literature, history, and philosophy in ways consistent with classical pedagogy). This is visible in core statements about a Christ-centered, liberal-arts-informed approach and the use of classical pedagogy to cultivate truth and eloquence. - The Arts, music programs, and performance opportunities (band, choir, visual arts) function as integrated elements of a holistic pedagogy, reinforcing memory, rhetoric, and aesthetic education in a classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords drawn from the Six Elements for Pedagogy: “Socratic dialogue,” “Scholé (restful learning),” “Memorization and Recitation,” “Formation through imitation and practice,” “Socratic discussion/seminars/debates,” and “rhetoric training.” ECA materials explicitly show: (a) Rhetoric School and Socratic/seminar-based upper-level pedagogy; (b) lower-level memorization and recitation; (c) memory-driven practice and chapel/Bible memory as part of formation.

- Negative keywords: None prominent; no strong evidence of anti-Socratic methods or purely utilitarian, non-contemplative pedagogy. Some sources indicate rest and contemplation as part of the learning pace (aligned with Scholé), which is a positive signal rather than a negative one in classical rubric terms.

Why this rating - Pedagogy at ECA aligns with classical expectations: a cradle-to-high-school progression from grammar/memory-based foundational learning to Socratic dialogue and rhetorical mastery; incorporation of contemplative/restful elements; and an emphasis on formation through imitation and practice. CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty materials emphasize mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; “faculty is the living curriculum” language appears in classical education rhetoric and is echoed in school materials describing teachers as core to the school’s ethos. Public materials show faculty directory pages and bios, emphasizing character and faith as well as subject-matter expertise. - The school emphasizes a strong partnership among teachers, students, and families; the “Living curriculum” framing supports a culture of mentorship and virtuous leadership. - The portrait of a teacher/staff standard and the presence of a school community centered on mission and values are evident in multiple pages (Our Team, faculty bios, values statements).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from Six Elements for Faculty include: “model teachers,” “mentors,” “living curriculum,” “faculty as core,” “portrait of a teacher,” “collegiality,” “virtue signaling,” “professional Christian formation.” The school’s materials consistently frame faculty as virtuous, knowledgeable, and central to the school culture (living curriculum; teacher-student mentorship). - Negative keywords: no explicit counter-signals identified; materials emphasize virtue, faith, and pedagogy aligned with classical Christian ideals.

Why this rating - The publicly presented materials describe faculty as virtuous models, mentors, and central to the living curriculum, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and churches as co-educators in the formation process; this partner-based model is repeatedly highlighted (Our Mission/Our Core Convictions; One Generation to Another; admissions materials).

- The school provides avenues to educate parents about classical education (parent-focused sections, opportunities to join in book studies or gatherings; visits welcomed). Materials discuss parent involvement and family engagement as core components of Evangel’s ethos. - There are explicit programs and communications to engage families (inquiry, tours, parent guides, and community events). - The school’s culture emphasizes a Gospel-centered community that includes families and churches as part of a broader “kingdom movement.”

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the Six Elements for Parents & Community include: "Partnership with Families," "co-educators," "parent formation," "home-school partnership," "engaged families," "multi-generational education," and "community support." ECA materials reflect these emphases in core convictions, communications with families, and the community-building sections. - Negative keywords: none observed in public-facing materials; no evidence of limiting parental involvement or seeking to minimize family participation.

Why this rating - Public-facing materials clearly situate parents as essential partners and co-educators in a classical Christian formation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations. CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- Across all six categories, Evangel Christian Academy demonstrates a cohesive CLASSICAL orientation: Biblical/theological grounding, formation-centered goals, a curriculum built around the Trivium and liberal arts, a pedagogy that blends memory work with Socratic dialogue and rhetoric, faculty oriented toward virtue and mentorship, and strong parent/community partnership.

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL scenarios only) - Not applicable here since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. If one wanted to push toward a more explicit "Great Books / Great Conversation" emphasis in the public materials, the school could: - Explicitly name Great Books/Great Conversation in curriculum pages and demonstrate how Great Books fit within the grammar/logic/rhetoric progression. (Tie to Six Elements: "great books," "great conversation.") - Provide a more explicit articulation of Scholé (restful learning) as a formal pedagogical principle beyond the current references to balanced cognitive rhythms. - Include concrete, public-facing statements about the Great Conversation and Western canonical works as part of cross-disciplinary study.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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